PHOENIX BUS

Driver Handbook and Safety Manual

Onboarding Procedure

1. Application
2. Obtain driver license, certificates, and medical card copies.
3. Review motor vehicle report (MVR)
4. Review clearinghouse
5. Pre-employment drug screening
6. Road test and/or certify via driver license
7. Medical card verification
8. Prior employment verification (up to 30 days for reply)
9. Insurance submittal and approval required
10. Hire driver
11. Request previous 7 days on duty hours
12. Provide polo shirt, safety book, copy of policies and all necessary items.

Operating Policy and Guidelines

Scheduling and Availability

Contact the dispatch team via text, phone call, or in person.

Maintenance Issues

Submit in DVIR, Notify Dispatch, and report to Safety and Maintenance Department.

Accidents

Notify dispatch immediately, follow the accident procedure, and report to safety manager.

Bus Cleanliness

Notify dispatch, send in photos via text to dispatch and report to outside services department.

Conflicts and Complaints

- Conflicts with other drivers: report to dispatch**
- Client conflict or complaint: report to dispatch**
- Conflicts with Dispatch team: report to operations manager
- Conflicts with Maintenance: report to safety manager**
- Conflicts with operations manager/management: report to Owners

**If conflict is unresolved, report to Operations manager

IMPORTANT CONTACTS

We at Phoenix Bus Orlando provide you with 24/7 Support. Below is the list of contacts that should be saved as a contact.

- Office Line: 407-574-7662
- 24/7 Driver Support/ Dispatch: 936-236-7526
  - Available 24/7, everyday including weekends and holidays
- Main Dispatch: 321-415-7255
  - Job orders, texts, and availability
- Office Dispatch: 407-874-3763
  - Only available Mon-Fri 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM
- Back up Dispatch: 689-500-7200
  - Only available Mon-Fri 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM

Note: all lines from dispatch also have WhatsApp available, if you are only able to connect to Wi-Fi.

Please make sure to save each contact separately in your phone.

If you have any questions or concerns, please contact one of the dispatchers in the office.

Uniform Policy

We are implementing a Phoenix Bus Orlando company uniform policy. Please review the policy below and sign.

Phoenix Bus will provide you with Black polo shirts with the Phoenix Bus logo.

**There will be a fee of $20.00 per shirt, if when you leave the company, it is not returned.

Uniform Requirements

- Dark Blue or Black slacks (no jeans or shorts)
- Phoenix Bus shirt or polo (must be tucked in)
- Black dress shoes or plain black sneakers (no sneaker crocs or other style shoes)

Items received

of shirts: _____ Size: _____ Condition of Items: _____

By signing below, I agree to the policy above and confirm I have received the items above.

_____ _____ _____

PRINT NAME SIGNATURE DATE

Returned Items:

of Shirts: _____ Size: _____

Damage (if applicable): _____ Date Returned: _____

_____ Charges (if applicable): _____

By signing below, I agree to the returned items information above.

_____ _____ _____

PRINT NAME SIGNATURE DATE

Office Personnel only:

By signing below, I agree that I have received the returned items in the condition above.

_____ _____ _____

PRINT NAME SIGNATURE DATE

NO Alcohol Policy

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that we are a great employer and handle our business affairs in a way that will create the safest possible work environment for our employees, drivers, and clients.

It is our policy to ensure that drug and alcohol problems are dealt with effectively and consistently so that workers are protected and those affected are encouraged to seek help. We expect all of those to whom this applies to support this policy and to comply with the rules below.

1. No Drinking while in possession of any vehicle owned and operated by Phoenix Bus Inc or any of its affiliates.
2. No Drinking while on any job whether in-state or out-of-state.
3. No Drinking at any hotel that is reserved by Phoenix Bus Inc or any of its affiliates.
4. No using any vehicle owned and operated by Phoenix Bus Inc or any of its affiliates to go on personal matters.
5. No disrespectful, loud, obnoxious, sexual or foul language, while operating or in possession of any vehicle owned and operated by Phoenix Bus Inc or any of its affiliates or at any hotel that is reserved by Phoenix Bus Inc or any of its affiliates.

There may be circumstances where we would ask you to provide a sample of your alcohol or illegal drug consumption. This may be part of an initiative to carry out random testing or otherwise. Any refusal to provide a test sample may lead to disciplinary action.

I have read and been given a copy of the company's policy on Alcohol. I understand that as a condition of employment, I am subject to its provisions, and to changes that may be made in the policy from time to time. I further understand that the Company may conduct drug and alcohol tests and/or search for the persons and belongings of its applicants and employees in accordance with the circumstances described in the policy. I hereby give my consent to the testing laboratory to release my test results to the Company's safety officer and to the Company's designated representative. I understand that if I refuse to submit to a drug or alcohol test or if I am found to be in violation of the Company's policy, I will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

_____	_____	_____
Driver Printed Name	Driver Signature	Date
_____	_____	_____
Manager Printed Name	Manager Signature	Date

ACCIDENT POLICY

We are implementing a Phoenix Bus Orlando company accident policy. Please review the policy and sign below.

STEPS FOLLOWING AN ACCIDENT

1. Get to safety off the main roadway
2. Call dispatch and advise the # of passengers on the bus.
3. Call 911 to get an official report filed (these reports can help with accident claims if the fault isn't clear) and ask for medical assistance, if needed.
4. Report to dispatch if any vehicle is being towed and if there are any injuries.
5. Exchange information with other drivers or witnesses
6. Take photos of damage to both vehicles/objects and surrounding areas and send them to Dispatch
7. Follow-up with dispatch and report if police show up to the accident scene.
8. Provide a detailed written statement.

_____ _____

PRINT NAME SIGNATURE

_____

DATE

Pre/Post Trip Inspection Policy

Purpose

This policy establishes clear guidelines for conducting mandatory pre-trip and post-trip inspections to ensure the safety, reliability, and compliance of all company buses.

Scope

This policy applies to all drivers and maintenance personnel operating or servicing vehicles owned, leased, or operated by Phoenix Bus Inc.

Pre-Trip Inspection Policy

Overview

All drivers are required to perform a pre-trip inspection prior to operating the bus each day or shift. The inspection must be thorough and documented using the company's approved inspection checklist.

Required Inspection Areas

Drivers must check the following before departure and include pictures of all four sides:

- Areas to Check:
  - Tires and wheels
  - Lights (headlights, brake lights, turn signals, hazard lights)
  - Mirrors and windshield
  - Leaks (under vehicle)
  - Doors and steps (secure and operational)
  - Body damage and cleanliness (with pictures)

Documentation & Reporting

- Drivers must complete a Pre-Trip Inspection Report and submit it before starting service.
- Any defect or unsafe condition must be immediately reported to dispatch/maintenance.
- No vehicle may be operated if a safety-related defect is found and unresolved.

Post-Trip Inspection Policy

Overview

After completing the last run or route of the day, all drivers must conduct a post-trip inspection to identify any new issues and ensure the vehicle is secure for the next use.

Required Inspection Areas

• Walk-around visual check of the bus for new damage or issues and include pictures of all four sides

• Interior sweep for:

- Lost and found items

• Lights, tires, leaks, and general wear

• Confirmation of proper parking and securing of vehicle.

Documentation & Reporting

- Complete a Post-Trip Inspection Report or note “no issues found.”
- Record any discovered issues and immediately notify maintenance if necessary.

-Sign and Submit the Post-Trip DVIR prior to departing the yard.

Compliance and Enforcement

- Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including suspension or termination.
- Inspections are subject to periodic audits by safety officers or fleet supervisors.
- Continuous training on inspection procedures will be provided annually.

Fuel and Log Policy

Purpose

This policy outlines procedures and responsibilities related to fuel usage and logging for all company-operated buses. It ensures accountability, promotes fuel efficiency, and maintains accurate operational records.

Scope

Applies to all drivers, dispatchers, and maintenance personnel involved in the operation and management of company vehicles.

Fuel Usage Policy

Fueling

- Only approved fueling stations may be used.
- Drivers must use designated fuel cards issued by the company.
- Must refuel the bus to a minimum of **¾ tank** or there will be a $30 surcharge deducted for non-fuel

Fuel Card Use

- Fuel cards are assigned per driver, and you must be logged into the bus.
- Personal use of company fuel cards is **strictly prohibited**.

Fuel Efficiency Expectations

- Drivers are expected to operate vehicles in a fuel-efficient manner.
- Idling should be minimized whenever possible.
- Reports of excessive fuel consumption will be investigated.

Driver Log Policy

Daily Logs

- Drivers must maintain accurate logs for each shift, including:
  - On-Duty Time
  - Drive Time (10 hours max)
  - Off Duty

Log Submission

- Logs must be submitted electronically or in physical form at the end of each shift or within 24 hours.
- Must certify the logs at the end of each shift.
- Any discrepancies must be reported to the dispatcher or fleet manager.

Responsibilities

Drivers:

- **Park your personal vehicle in the same space as your bus!**
  - Drivers in violation will receive 1 written notice and will be fined/towed if they continue to repeat the issue.
  - 1st offense after warning: $25.00 fine
  - 2nd offense: $50.00 fine
  - 3rd offense: Vehicle will be towed at owners' expense
- Use fuel cards appropriately.
- Report issues or anomalies immediately.

Fleet Manager:

- Monitor fuel consumption trends.
- Review and approve log entries.
- Ensure compliance with the policy.

---

7. Violations

- Violations of this policy may result in warnings, suspension, or termination, depending on the severity and recurrence.

Scratch and Dent Policy

Purpose

This policy outlines procedures for identifying, reporting, documenting, and addressing scratches, dents, and minor cosmetic damage on all buses operated by Phoenix Bus Inc. The goal is to maintain vehicle appearance, ensure public confidence, and support accountability among employees.

Scope

This policy applies to all drivers, maintenance personnel, supervisors, and any staff responsible for the operation or care of the company buses.

Definitions

- **Scratch:** A superficial mark or abrasion that affects only the paint or surface layer.
- **Dent:** A deformation of the bus bodywork, typically without loss of paint but noticeable to the eye.
- **Minor Damage:** Any non-structural blemish that does not affect the safety or operation of the vehicle.

Reporting Procedures

Pre-Trip Inspection

- Drivers must inspect their assigned vehicle before each shift using the company's standard Pre-Trip Inspection Checklist.
- All existing scratches, dents, or cosmetic damage must be documented and reported to a supervisor before departure.

Incident Reporting

- Any new damage found or caused during a shift must be reported **immediately** upon return to the depot or, if necessary, from the road.
    - Photos of the damage (if possible)

End-of-Shift Inspection

- A post-trip inspection must be conducted by the driver or an assigned maintenance staff member.
- New damages must be reported in the same manner as above.

Responsibility and Accountability

- **Drivers** are responsible for the condition of the bus while under their care. Failure to report damage may result in disciplinary action.
- **Maintenance Staff** will assess reported damage and determine if repairs are necessary.
- **Supervisors** will review reports and investigate damage that appears negligent or unreported.

Repair Policy

- Minor cosmetic damages will be scheduled for repair during routine maintenance, unless safety is affected.
- Major or repetitive damage may require immediate attention.
- Chronic or repeated damage incidents by the same employee may result in retraining or disciplinary action.

Disciplinary Action

- **Failure to report damage:** Could be ground for termination.
- **Negligent damage:** Will be investigated and may result in disciplinary measures including $500 fine and/or up to termination.
- **Deliberate damage or cover-up:** Subject to immediate investigation and potential termination.

Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually and updated as necessary by the Operations Manager and Safety Officer.

Signed: Michelle Perez

Michelle Perez

Operations Manager

Wheelchair Lift Operating Policy

Introduction

This manual provides step-by-step instructions on the safe and proper operation of a wheelchair lift.

Safety Precautions

Before using the lift:

- **Read the manual completely.**
- Ensure the lift is installed by a qualified technician.
- Keep hands, feet, and loose clothing clear of all moving parts.
- Never exceed the lift's maximum weight capacity.
- Only operate the lift on level ground unless it's a vehicle-mounted model designed for slope use.
- Children should not operate the lift unsupervised.
- **IMPORTANT: Wheelchair loads first and off last onto the bus.**

Components Overview

Typical wheelchair lifts include:

- **Platform**: The flat surface where the wheelchair sits.
- **Control Panel**: For operating the lift (can be handheld, fixed, or remote).
- **Safety Rails/Barriers**: Prevents rolling off during movement.
- **Power Supply**: Battery or plug-in (AC/DC).
- **Emergency Stop Button**: Halts operation instantly.

Operating the Wheelchair Lift

Preparing the Lift

1. **Ensure Power is On**
    - Turn on the power switch (if applicable).
    - Check the power light/indicator to confirm operation.
2. **Inspect for Obstructions**

    - Make sure the platform is clear of debris or objects.
    - Confirm the lift path (up/down) is not blocked.
3. **Deploy the Platform (if stowed)**
    - For vehicle lifts, press “Deploy” or “Unfold” to extend the lift.

Boarding the Platform

1. Lower the platform to ground level using the control panel.
2. Open safety barriers (if equipped).
3. Roll the wheelchair onto the platform facing forward.
4. Lock wheelchair brakes.
5. Close safety barriers or secure belts, if applicable.

Operating the Lift

1. Once on the platform, press the **“Up”** or **“Lift”** button to ascend.
    - Or **“Down”** to descend, depending on your location.
2. The platform will stop automatically at the top/bottom landing.
3. Wait for the lift to fully stop before exiting.

Exiting the Platform

1. Open safety barriers.
2. Release wheelchair brakes and carefully roll off the platform.
3. For vehicle lifts, press **“Stow”** to fold the lift into its storage position.

Emergency Procedures

In the event the lift becomes stuck or unable to operate while in an open position and off the ground there is a passenger on the lift, please follow the following

1. Stop all operations of the lift
2. Call 911 and inform you have a passenger on the lift
3. Keep passenger calm, and keep the area free from all distractions and obstructions
4. Call Dispatch immediately and inform of the situation.

Passenger Safety Instructions

Welcome Aboard!

Thank you for choosing **Phoenix Bus Orlando.** Your safety is our top priority. Please take a moment to review this important safety information.

Before Departure

- Please remain seated while the bus is boarding and during departure.
- Place all personal items securely in the overhead compartments.
- If your bus has Seatbelts, they are available for your safety and use.

In Case of Emergency

- Emergency exits are located at the front and may include side windows or roof hatches.
- Please familiarize yourself with the nearest emergency exit.
- In the event of an emergency, follow the driver's instructions immediately.
- Fire extinguishers are located at the front of the bus.

During the Ride

- Stay seated while the bus is moving.
- Do not distract the driver.
- Keep aisles clear of personal belongings at all times.
- Smoking, including electronic cigarettes, is strictly prohibited.
- Use of loud music or phone conversations that disturb other passengers is not allowed.

Restroom Use

- Please use the onboard restroom only when necessary and ensure the door is securely locked.
- Be cautious while walking to the restroom, especially when the bus is in motion.

Electronics and Connectivity

- You may use mobile devices and electronics with headphones.
- Charging ports and Wi-Fi (if available) are provided for your convenience. Please use them responsibly.

Accessibility

- Priority seating is reserved for seniors and passengers with disabilities.
- If you require assistance boarding or exiting, please inform the driver in advance.

Arrival and Departure

- Remain seated until the bus comes to a complete stop.
- Check your seat and overhead area for personal belongings before exiting.
- Exit carefully and only through designated doors.

Thank you for traveling with **Phoenix Bus Orlando.**

We’re committed to providing you with a safe and comfortable journey.

Electronic Logging Device (ELD) Regulations

The ELD regulations apply to most motor carriers of passengers and their drivers who are required to keep a record of duty status. These regulations apply to drivers domiciled in Canada and Mexico when operating within the United States, unless they qualify for an exception.

Exceptions to the ELD Regulations:

1. Drivers who are required to prepare a record of duty status no more than 8 days during any 30-day period.
2. Driveaway-towaway operations if the vehicle is part of the shipment (for example, transporting an empty vehicle for sale, lease, or repair).
3. Drivers of vehicles manufactured before model year 2000.

Motor carriers of passengers must choose only ELDs that are self-certified and registered on FMCSA's website. To get more ELD information, including Frequently Asked Questions, visit www.fmcsa.dot.gov/elds.

Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration

www.fmcsa.dot.gov

Hours of Service for Motor Carriers of Passengers

This brochure is intended to provide general regulatory information for passenger operations and is not a substitute for the Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations.

FMCSA-E-06-006 July 2022

U.S. Department of Transportation
Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration

www.fmcsa.dot.gov

Part 395: Hours of Service for Motor Carriers of Passengers

General—Part 395

The hours-of-service rules for drivers of passenger-carrying commercial motor vehicles (CMVs) are different from the rules for property-carrying CMVs. Note that Non-Business Private Motor Carriers of Passengers are not subject to the record keeping requirements of these rules, such as maintaining a record of duty status or using an electronic logging device.

Maximum Driving Time for Passenger-Carrying Vehicles—§ 395.5

No motor carrier of passengers shall permit or require any passenger-carrying CMV driver to drive:

- More than 10 hours following 8 consecutive hours off duty, or
- For any period after having been on duty 15 hours following 8 consecutive hours off duty.

No motor carrier of passengers shall permit or require any passenger-carrying CMV driver to drive, regardless of number of motor carriers using the driver's services, for any period after the driver has been on duty:

- 60 hours in any 7 consecutive days if the carrier does not operate CMVs every day of the week; or
- 70 hours in any 8 consecutive days if the carrier operates CMVs every day of the week.

Off-Duty Time

"Off-duty time" is not specifically defined in the regulations. In effect, it is any time that is not "driving time," "on-duty time," or "sleeper berth" as defined in § 395.2.

The following guidelines must be met before a driver is considered off duty for meal and other routine stops made during a work shift:

- The driver must be relieved of all duty and responsibility for the care and custody of the bus or passenger-carrying CMV, its accessories, and any passengers, baggage, and freight that it may be transporting.
- During the stop, and for the duration of the stop, the driver must be at liberty to pursue activities of his/her own choosing.

On-Duty Time—§ 395.2

On-duty time means all time from the time a driver begins work or is required to be in readiness for work until the time the driver is relieved from work and all responsibilities for performing work. Performing other compensated work for a person who is not a motor carrier is also on-duty time. The complete definition of on-duty time can be found in § 395.2.

Travel Time—§ 395.1(j)

When a driver, at the direction of a motor carrier, is traveling but not driving any vehicle or assuming any other responsibility to the carrier (sometimes referred to as "cushioning"), such time shall be counted as on-duty time unless the driver is afforded at least 8 consecutive hours off duty when arriving at destination, in which case he/she shall be considered off duty for the entire period.

Relief Drivers

On long-distance trips requiring straight-through driving, motor carriers of passengers may send a relief driver ahead.

1. In cases when the driver is driven or uses public transportation to get to a layover location, and the driver has 8 consecutive hours off duty after arriving, travel time may be recorded as off duty.
2. If the CMV driver drives him/herself in a non-CMV, time spent driving the non-CMV to a layover location must be recorded as on duty, not driving.

Exception—§ 395.1(e)

A driver is exempt from the logbook or record of duty status requirements if he/she operates within a 150 air-mile radius of the normal work reporting location and is released from duty within 14 consecutive hours or less.

Sleeper Berth—§ 395.1(g)(3)

A driver who is driving a passenger-carrying CMV that is equipped with a sleeper berth, as defined in § 393.76, may accumulate the equivalent of 8 consecutive hours off-duty time by taking two periods of rest in the sleeper berth, provided that the four requirements of § 395.1(g)(3)(i) - (iv) are met.

Multiple Employer Driver—§ 395.8(j)

Some passenger carriers make frequent use of part-time and multiple-employer drivers. When using a driver intermittently, obtain a signed statement from the driver that indicates the total time on duty during the preceding 7 days and the time at which the driver was last relieved from duty prior to using such driver. All compensated work for a motor carrier or a non-motor carrier is on-duty time.